PITCHER EVALUATION · R&D ADVANCE REPORT

Kevin Gausman

CHC · RHP · Starter · Age 35 · 3,005 pitches · 32 G

Pitcher evaluation
2026 regular season
Data through **2026-09-27**
MLBAM 592332

IP	ERA	FIP	XFIP	XERA	K%	BB%	K-BB%	CSW%	WHIFF%	CHASE%	FB VELO
177.2	4.51	3.74	3.58	4.02	24.5%	6.3%	18.3%	28.7%	25.6%	35.0%	93.8

BOTTOM LINE

1. **Predictable in 3-1 vs LHH:** 79% four-seams (n=39) — the count a hitter can sit on one pitch.
2. **Tunnel pair FF/SL:** 2.8 in apart at the decision point, 15.8 in at the plate (5.7× late separation).
3. **Opportunity in 2-2 vs LHH:** throws four-seam 57%; the situational model prefers sweeper (.269 vs .281 expected xwOBA, n=149).
4. **Fades third time through:** xwOBA .283 first time vs .320 third+ (+37 pts).
5. **Average run prevention by xERA:** 4.51 ERA, 4.02 xERA (52nd pct), 3.74 FIP, 18.3% K-BB.

20–80 GRADES

vs 424 pitchers ≥600 pitches

Stuff	45	-0.10 RV/100
Command	50	BB 6.3%
Bat-missing	55	Whiff 26%
Contact mgmt	45	xwOBAcon .379
Durability	60	IP/GS 5.5

ARSENAL Arsenal — four-seam is the best pitch by shape (50 Stuff, average)

Velo mph · spin rpm · IVB/HB inches, catcher view (HB + = toward 1B) · Ext ft · Whiff per swing · Chase = swing % outside zone · xwOBA per PA ended · RV/100 = count-neutral run value per 100 pitches, + = good for pitcher · cells tinted by percentile within pitch type & hand · grey rows: n < 100

	USAGE				USAGE BY COUNT				SHAPE					RESULTS					GRADES (20–80)		
PITCH	N	ALL	VL	VR	0-0	AHD	BHD	2K	VELO	SPIN	IVB	HB	EXT	WHIFF	CHASE	CSW	XWOBA	RV/100	STUFF	RES	CMD
Four-seam FF	1521	**51%**	51%	50%	53%	40%	59%	45%	93.8	2293	16.9	-10.5	6.7	12%	30%	31%	.343	+0.8	50	50	65
Splitter FS	1177	**39%**	44%	32%	30%	48%	35%	48%	84.0	1566	4.3	-13.9	6.8	42%	41%	27%	.245	-0.1	45	60	45
Slider SL	244	**8%**	2%	16%	13%	9%	5%	6%	84.1	2266	3.4	1.0	6.7	35%	22%	23%	.434	-3.0	35	40	35
Changeup CH	35	**1%**	1%	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	83.9	1442	14.9	-5.0	6.8	19%	33%	23%	.150	+2.0	45	55	35
Sweeper ST	26	**1%**	0%	2%	2%	1%	0%	1%	79.7	2471	2.3	11.2	6.6	33%	20%	27%	.426	-2.1	40	35	45

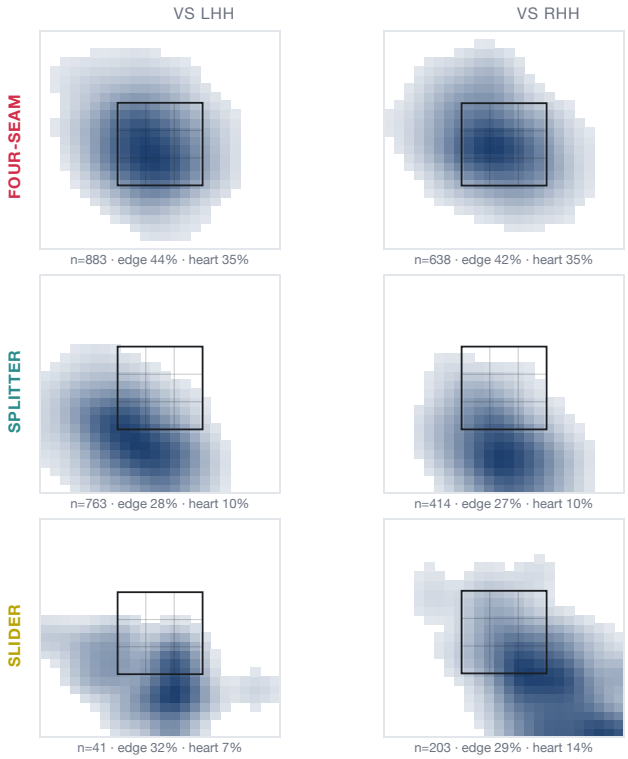
SHAPE Movement — four-seam carries 1.3 in more IVB than the average RHP four-seam

Dots = individual pitches (≤110 per type); large markers = his averages; dashed ellipses = league 1-SD shape for the same pitch type from RHPs. Inches, catcher view.



LOCATION Location — 35% of his four-seams finish in the upper third or above

Smoothed density of pitch locations (catcher view; box = average rule-book zone, thirds marked). Darker = more frequent (frequency, not quality) · edge = within ±3 in of the zone border.



COUNTS Count strategy — most predictable in 3-1 vs LHH (79% four-seam)

Throws most = his most-used pitch in each count (tint: red = mixed, blue = ≥70% one pitch, i.e. predictable). Model pick = lowest expected xwOBA from the situational model vs a league-average hitter (◆ = differs). Mix gap = his actual mix's model xwOBA minus the model pick's, in points (.001); blue = larger opportunity.

VS LHH	0-0	1-0	2-0	3-0	0-1	1-1	2-1	3-1	0-2	1-2	2-2	3-2
Throws most	FF 53% n=426	FF 51% n=168	FF 51% n=51	FF 100% n=19	FF 50% n=213	FF 54% n=164	FF 52% n=80	FF 79% n=39	FS 59% n=124	FS 59% n=189	FF 57% n=149	FF 61% n=94
Model pick	ST ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	FS ◆	ST ◆	ST ◆	ST ◆	SL ◆	FF ◆	ST ◆	ST ◆	FS ◆
Mix gap (pts)	7	7	9	13	4	5	8	25	2	2	8	8

VS RHH	0-0	1-0	2-0	3-0	0-1	1-1	2-1	3-1	0-2	1-2	2-2	3-2
Throws most	FF 54% n=327	FF 59% n=109	FF 55% n=38	FF 100% n=11	FF 42% n=180	FF 50% n=117	FF 62% n=64	FF 70% n=23	FS 46% n=114	FS 53% n=154	FF 52% n=97	FF 60% n=53
Model pick	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	FS ◆	FF	ST ◆	ST ◆	SL ◆	FF ◆	FF ◆	ST ◆	FS ◆
Mix gap (pts)	3	4	6	10	5	1	5	26	7	4	4	6

MOST PREDICTABLE

3-1 vs LHH · **79% FF** n=39
2-1 vs RHH · **62% FF** n=64
3-2 vs LHH · **61% FF** n=94

LARGEST MODEL GAPS

2-2 vs LHH · FF 57% → **ST** .281→.269
0-0 vs LHH · FF 53% → **ST** .262→.256
3-1 vs LHH · FF 79% → **SL** .343→.323

SEQUENCE Sequencing — FF/SL is the best tunnel pair (5.7× separation after the decision point)

Share (%) of next pitch within the same PA, by previous pitch. Tunnel = mean trajectories 23.8 ft from the plate vs at the plate.

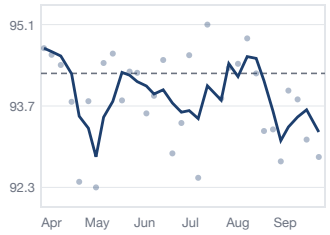
AFTER ↓ / NEXT →	FF	FS	SL
FF n=1104	50	40	7
FS n=890	49	47	3
SL n=204	49	32	19

Best tunnel: **FF/SL** — 2.8 in apart at the decision point, 15.8 in apart at the plate (5.7× late separation; release 2.1 in apart)
Splitter after SL: **54% whiff** vs 42% overall (39 swings)
Slider after FF: **37% whiff** vs 35% overall (35 swings)

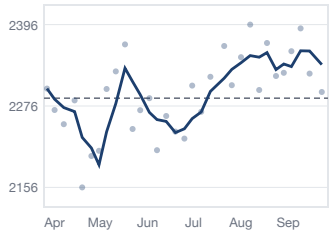
TRENDS Trends — stable through the season

Per game (dots), 3-game rolling mean (line), dashed = baseline before last 5 games; ⚑ shaded = flagged window (≥1 mph, 75 rpm or 0.2 ft). No IL stints.

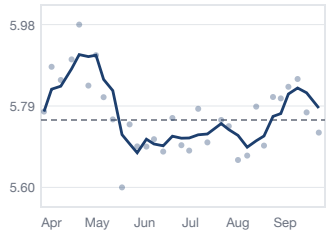
Primary FB velo (mph)



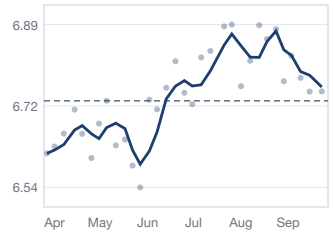
Primary FB spin (rpm)



Release height (ft)



Extension (ft)



SPLITS Splits — even platoon profile (15-pt xwOBA gap)

Statcast PAs, regular season. xwOBA tint vs league .315 (red = better for him). Times through order use the batter's PA count vs this pitcher in the game. Velo hold: primary FB +0.2 mph on pitches 76+ vs 1–25. Grey rows: < 60 PA.

SPLIT	PA	WOBA	XWOBA	K%	BB%	HR	WHIFF	CHASE
vs LHH	419	.313	.302	23.2%	7.2%	11	24%	33%
vs RHH	323	.330	.317	26.9%	5.0%	15	28%	37%
1st time	286	.277	.283	25.5%	5.9%	4	25%	35%
2nd time	282	.345	.327	25.9%	6.4%	13	26%	36%
3rd+ time	174	.352	.320	21.8%	6.3%	9	26%	33%

COMPS Comps — closest arsenal profile: Tyler Mahle

Nearest neighbors among qualified pitchers on pitch mix, primary-FB velo/IVB/HB, arm angle, breaking-ball shape and separation, whiff% and zone% (standardized, weighted). Chip = comp's Stuff grade.

Tyler Mahle ATL 45 — 60% similar
RHP SP · FB 92.8 mph, 17" IVB · FF 48% / FS 30% / FC 15%

Kyle Finnegan DET 55 — 53% similar
RHP RP · FB 96.2 mph, 18" IVB · FF 52% / FS 32% / SL 17%

Brandon Young BAL 45 — 48% similar
RHP SP · FB 94.4 mph, 18" IVB · FF 40% / FS 19% / SL 16% / SI 14% / CU 12%

DEVELOP Development notes — usage direction from the arsenal optimizer

Constrained optimizer on the outcome model (each pitch ±15 pts, 3–55% bounds). Expected gains are small and model-dependent: hypotheses for the pitching staff, not prescriptions.

vs LHH: FF 52→41%, FS 45→55% (model xwOBA -4 pts, n=1710)
vs RHH: FF 50→35%, FS 33→48% (model xwOBA -5 pts, n=1267)
Shape: his splitter grades 45 Stuff. Top-quartile RHP splitters average 10.1 in of arm-side break vs his 13.9 — the largest gap; worth a look in pitch design, not a prescription.

Grades. each scale is a z-score composite converted to a percentile within the qualified pool, then 50 + 10·Φ⁻¹(p), clipped 20–80 and shown to the nearest 5. Pitch grades are within the same pitch type and throwing hand (≥100 pitches). Stuff = a gradient-boosted model of expected, count-neutral run value from velo, movement, spin, extension, release, arm angle and separation from the primary fastball (no location or results; held-out pitch-type correlation r=0.37). Results = whiff%, CSW%, xwOBA. Command = edge%, waste%, heart% (pitch) and BB%, edge, zone, first-strike (overall). Durability = IP/start, pitches/game, late-game velo hold (relievers: G, IP). **Models.** count plan = situational pitch-type model (2026, generic league-average hitter, medium leverage, 2nd time through); location/tunneling from Statcast trajectory fits at a 23.8 ft decision point; usage suggestion = constrained arsenal optimizer (±15 pts/pitch). Model gaps are small effects — treat as direction. **Caveats.** single season, regular season only; small-sample cells greyed; xwOBA ignores park and defense; IL dates from MLB transactions (retroactive dates honored).